

# Dr. Christopher E. Mason





# MetaSUB: Building a Global Network to Map Urban Microbial Life

*Founded in 2015, the **MetaSUB Consortium** created a worldwide, interdisciplinary network to sample and sequence microbes from transit systems, sewage, hospitals, and other urban environments across more than 100 countries.*

 **iScience**  
A Cell Press journal

[This journal](#) [Journals](#) [Publish](#) [News & events](#) [About Cell Press](#)

BACKSTORY · Volume 25, Issue 11, 104993, November 18, 2022 · [Open Access](#)

## A history of the MetaSUB consortium: Tracking urban microbes around the globe

[Krista A. Ryon](#)<sup>4,5</sup> · [Braden T. Tierney](#)<sup>4,5</sup> · [Alina Frolova](#)<sup>1,2</sup> · [Andre Kahles](#)<sup>3,35</sup> · [Christelle Desnues](#)<sup>6</sup> · [Christos Ouzounis](#)<sup>9</sup> · [Cynthia Gibas](#)<sup>10</sup> · [Daniela Bezdán](#)<sup>11,12,13</sup> · [Youping Deng](#)<sup>36</sup> · [Ding He](#)<sup>14</sup> · [Emmanuel Dias-Neto](#)<sup>15</sup> · [Eran Elhaik](#)<sup>16</sup> · [Evan Afshin](#)<sup>7</sup> · [George Grills](#)<sup>17</sup> · [Gregorio Iraola](#)<sup>18</sup> · [Haruo Suzuki](#)<sup>19</sup> · [Johannes Werner](#)<sup>20</sup> · [Klas Udekwu](#)<sup>21</sup> · [Lynn Schriml](#)<sup>22</sup> · [Malay Bhattacharyya](#)<sup>23</sup> · [Manuela Oliveira](#)<sup>24</sup> · [Maria Mercedes Zambrano](#)<sup>25</sup> · [Nur Hazlin Hazrin-Chong](#)<sup>26</sup> · [Olayinka Osuolale](#)<sup>27</sup> · [Paweł P. Łabaj](#)<sup>28</sup> · [Prisca Tiasse](#)<sup>29</sup> · [Sampath Rapuri](#)<sup>30</sup> · [Silvia Borrás](#)<sup>31</sup> · [Sofya Pozdniakova](#)<sup>31</sup> · [Tielu Shi](#)<sup>32</sup> · [Ugur Sezerman](#)<sup>33</sup> · [Xavier Rodo](#)<sup>31</sup> · [Zehra Hazal Sezer](#)<sup>34</sup> · [Christopher E. Mason](#)<sup>7,8</sup>  [Show less](#)

[Affiliations & Notes](#)  [Article Info](#) 

 [Download PDF](#)  [Cite](#)  [Share](#)  [Set Alert](#)  [Get Rights](#)  [Reprints](#)

 Summary

Show Outline

The MetaSUB Consortium, founded in 2015, is a global consortium with an interdisciplinary team of clinicians, scientists, bioinformaticians, engineers, and designers, with members from more than 100 countries across the globe. This network has continually collected samples from urban and rural sites including subways and transit systems, sewage systems, hospitals, and other environmental sampling. These collections have been ongoing since 2015 and have continued when possible, even throughout the COVID-19 pandemic. The consortium has optimized their workflow for the collection, isolation, and sequencing of DNA and RNA collected from these various sites and processing them for metagenomics analysis, including the identification of SARS-CoV-2 and its variants. Here, the Consortium describes its foundations, and its ongoing work to expand on this network and to focus its scope on the mapping, annotation, and prediction of emerging pathogens, mapping microbial evolution and antibiotic resistance, and the discovery of novel organisms and biosynthetic gene clusters.